

Divine Omniscience

doc-divine-omniscience

Theology Proper · Attributes · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

God knows all things (actual and possible, past, present, and future) exhaustively and eternally, including all future free human actions.

In plain language

Across both Testaments the words point clearly to God knowing all things exhaustively and eternally. In Psalm 139 the verb yada (Strong H3045, queried at 945 occurrences in the Hebrew text) is used for God searching the writer, knowing his sitting and rising, his ways, and a word before it reaches the tongue. The phrase eyn millah bilshoni declares there is no word in the mouth that God does not already know. Isaiah 40:28 adds eyn cheqer, no searching out of his understanding, and Isaiah 46:10 has maggid mereshit acharit, declaring the end from the beginning. The New Testament continues the pattern. First John 3:20 puts ginoskei panta, knows all things, with God as subject, the object made total. Hebrews 4:13 stacks the negation ouk estin ktisis aphanes, no creature is hidden, with the perfect participles gymna and tetrachelismena, all things bare and laid open to his eyes. Matthew 26:34 has Jesus predict Peter denying him three times before the rooster crows, and Acts 2:23 binds foreknowledge with the divine plan, so future free human acts are spoken of as foreknown. The recurring terms and their spread across narrative, wisdom, prophecy, gospel, and letter make the pattern decisive. Where readers diverge is on a small set of texts that sound like God learning. Genesis 22:12 says now I know that you fear God, but the verb there is the very same form of yada used in 1 Kings 8:39 for God alone knowing every heart, and the chapter opens by saying God tested Abraham, the same testing-plus-knowing pairing found in Deuteronomy 8:2, so the words read as knowledge shown by a test rather than knowledge gained. Genesis 18:21 has God descend to see, the speech of a judge coming to act. Jeremiah 19:5 says a thing did not come up on my heart, but the same idiom in Jeremiah 7:31 and 32:35 means God did not command or will it. So the divergence is genuinely lexical. It hangs on whether these knowing and testing idioms are accommodated narrative speech or real limits, and on whether a future free choice is known as settled fact or open possibility. The wider word pattern weighs toward accommodated idiom and settled knowing.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0319	אַחֲרִית	acharit	end	61
H0369	אֵין	ayin	nothing	788
H0410	אל	el	God	
H0657	אָפֶּס	ephes	end	
H1847	דָּעַת	daath	knowledge	93
H1870	דֶּרֶךְ	derekh	way	
H2713	חָקַר	chaqar	to search	
H2714	חֶקֶר	cheqer	search	

H3045	יָדַע	yada	to know	945
H3605	כָּל	kol	all	5,413
H3808	לֹא	lo	not	5,186
H3820	לֵב	lev	heart	
H3824	לִבָּב	levav	heart	
H4284	מַחֲשָׁבָה	machashavah	plot	
H4405	מִלָּה	millah	speech	
H5046	נָגַד	nagad	to tell	370
H5254	נָסָה	nasah	to test	
H5927	עָלָה	alah	to ascend	
H6098	עֲצָה	etsah	counsel	89
H6213	עָשָׂה	asah	to make	2,629
H6383	פֶּלִיאַ	peliah	incomprehensible	2
H7200	רָאָה	raah	to see	
H7225	רֵשִׁית	reshit	first	51
H7350	רָחוֹק	rachok	distant	
H8394	תַּבִּינָה	tavunah	understanding	
G0220	ἀλεκτωρ	alektōr	rooster	
G0281	ἀμήν	amēn	amen	
G0459	ἄνομος	anomos	lawless	
G0533	ἀπαρνέομαι	aparneomai	to deny	
G0852	ἀφανής	aphanes	hidden	1
G1012	βουλή	boule	plan	12
G1097	γινώσκω	ginosko	to know	222
G1131	γυμνός	gymnos	naked	15
G1344	δικαιόω	dikaioō	to justify	
G1392	δοξάζω	doxazō	to glorify	
G1754	ἐνεργέω	energeo	be active	21
G1799	ἐνώπιον	enopion	before	94
G2307	θέλημα	thelema	will/desire	62
G2564	καλέω	kaleō	to call	
G2588	καρδία	kardia	heart	156
G3724	ὀρίζω	horizō	to determine	
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	1,243
G4267	προγινώσκω	proginosko	to know/choose	5
G4268	πρόγνωσις	prognōsis	foreknowledge	
G4309	προορίζω	proorizo	to predestine	6
G4832	σύμμορφος	summorphos	conformed	

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The lexical pattern across both Testaments presents God knowing all things exhaustively and eternally. In the OSHB Hebrew layer the verb yada (H3045, queried at 945 word occurrences over 874 verses, OT only) is the qal perfect predicate over Ps 139, where *eyn millah bilshoni* (H0369 plus H4405) negates any word God does not already know. Isa 46:10 stacks *maggid* (H5046) with the temporal pair *reshit* (H7225) and *acharit* (H0319) plus *etsah* (H6098) *taqum* to declare the end from the beginning. The Greek lexicon adds *proginosko* (G4267), *proorizo* (G4309), *ginoskei panta* (G1097 plus G3956) in 1 John 3:20, and the absolute negation *ouk estin ktisis aphanes* (G0852) in Heb 4:13. The complicating now-I-know texts use the same qal-perfect yada inside a *nasah* testing frame (Gen 22:1 H5254 then Gen 22:12 H3045, paired explicitly in Deut 8:2), so they read as demonstration, not acquisition. Pan-canonical density is high and the verdict is variant robust.

Scripture

Ps.139.1 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3045 יָדַע, H2713 תִּקַּר,

Force. YHWH is addressed with *chaqartani* (you have searched me) and the qal imperfect-consecutive *wattedaa* (and you know me). The opening colon places exhaustive personal knowing as the controlling predicate over the whole psalm. Queried yada (H3045) here is the same root that recurs in verses 2 and 4.

Ps.139.2 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: merism

Key terms. H3045 יָדַע, H7350 רָחֹק,

Force. *yadata shivti uqumi* pairs sitting and rising as a merism of total daily action, and *merachok* adds spatial distance. The queried yada here is qal perfect 2ms (HVqp2ms), identical in form to the divine heart-knowing of 1 Kgs 8:39. The lexical force is that no posture or distance limits the divine knowing.

Ps.139.3 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3605 כֹּל; H1870 דֶּרֶךְ,

Force. *wekol derakhay hiskantah* uses *kol* (H3605, the highest-frequency totalizing quantifier in the OSHB layer at over five thousand occurrences) with *derek* to assert that all my ways are familiar to YHWH. The object of the knowing is grammatically total.

Ps.139.4 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H0369 אֵין, H4405 מְלָה, H3045 יָדַע,

Force. *ki eyn millah bilshoni hen yadata kullah* states that before a word is on the tongue YHWH already knows the whole of it. The existential negator *ayin* (H0369) forecloses any prior moment in which the word is unknown to God, so the construction asserts prior knowledge of an unspoken word.

Ps.139.6 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H1847 דַּעַת, H6383 פֶּלִיאַ,

Force. *peliah daat mimmenni nisgevah* confesses that this knowledge is too wonderful and too high. *peliah* (H6383) is a near-hapax, queried at only two occurrences in the canon (here and Judg 13:18, of the angel's wonderful name), so the speaker grades the divine knowing as qualitatively beyond creaturely reach.

Isa.40.28 · **for** · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H2714 חֶקֶר, H8394 תִּבְנוּנָה

Force. eyn cheqer litvunato states there is no searching out of his understanding. The noun cheqer (H2714, searching) under the negator eyn declares that the divine understanding has no findable limit, the positive counterpart to the creature unable to reach it in Ps 139:6. Ps 147:5 echoes this with tevunah (H8394) ein mispar.

Isa.46.9 · **for** · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אֵל, H0657 אֶפֶס

Force. anoki el we-eyn od we-efes kamoni places God in an exclusivity claim. The piled negations eyn (H0369) and efes (H0657) deny any peer who could rival the knowing asserted in the next verse, so the omniscience claim is grounded in unique deity.

Isa.46.10 · **for** · genre: prophecy · figures: merism

Key terms. H5046 נָגַד, H7225 רָאִשִׁית, H0319 אַחֲרִית, H6098 עָצָה

Force. maggid mereshit acharit umiqqedem asher lo naasu declares the end from the beginning, and from antiquity what is not yet done. The hiphil participle maggid (nagad, H5046) with the temporal pair reshith (H7225) and acharit (H0319) asserts present declaration of future events. atsati taqum we-kol cheftsi eeseh adds that the divine counsel (etsah, H6098) stands and every desire is enacted, so prior knowing and prior purpose are joined.

Ps.94.11 · **for** · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3045 יָדַע, H4284 מַחְשְׁבֹה

Force. YHWH yodea machshevot adam states that the LORD knows the thoughts of man. Queried yada here is the qal participle (HVqrmsa), framing the knowing as a standing characteristic, and the object machshevot (thoughts) makes inner cognition the field of divine knowledge.

1Kgs.8.39 · **for** · genre: narrative

Key terms. H3045 יָדַע, H3824 לֵבָב

Force. attah yadata levadeka eth levav kol bene haadam confesses that you alone know the heart of all the sons of men. Queried yada here is qal perfect 2ms (HVqp2ms), the exact morphological form used in Ps 139:2 and 4, which is the positive control showing that the verb form itself carries exhaustive divine heart-knowledge.

1John.3.20 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1097 γινώσκω, G3956 πᾶς, G2588 καρδιά

Force. meizon estin ho theos tes kardias hemon kai ginoskei panta states that God is greater than our heart and knows all things. The neuter plural panta (G3956) as object of the present indicative ginoskei (G1097) makes the field of knowing exhaustive with no temporal qualifier.

Heb.4.13 · **for** · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0852 ἀφανής, G1131 γυμνός, G1799 ἐνώπιον

Force. ouk estin ktisis aphanes enopion autou panta de gymna kai tetrachelismena tois ophthalmois autou denies any creature is hidden before him and declares all things bare and exposed to his eyes. aphanes (G0852) is a queried hapax (one canon occurrence), and the perfect passive pair gymna and tetrachelismena secures both the totality and the durative state of exposure.

Matt.26.34 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0281 ἀμήν, G0220 ἀλέκτωρ, G0533 ἀπαρνέομαι

Force. amen lego soi hoti en taute te nykti prin alektora phonesai tris aparnese me records a future free human act predicted in advance with numeric precision (three times) and a timing marker (before the rooster crows). The lexical force is foreknowledge of a future free choice down to count and timing.

Acts.2.23 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G3724 ὀρίζω, G4268 πρόγνωσις, G1012 βουλή, G0459 ἄνομος

Force. te horismene boule kai prognosei tou theou couples the definite plan of God with his prior knowledge. The dative prognosei (G4268) conjoined with boule (G1012) grounds the free human action of lawless executioners (anomos, G0459) in a prior divine knowing, so a future free act is held as foreknown.

Eph.1.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4309 προορίζω, G1012 βουλή, G2307 θέλημα, G1754 ἐνεργέω, G3956 πᾶς

Force. prooristhentes kata prothesin tou ta panta energountos kata ten boulen tou theleματος autou places predetermination in line with the one who works all things (ta panta, G3956) according to the counsel of his will. The genitive present participle energountos (G1754) with ta panta asserts exhaustive providential operation rooted in prior counsel.

Rom.8.29 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4267 προγινώσκω, G4309 προορίζω, G4832 σύμμορφος

Force. hous proegno kai proorisen symmorphous tes eikonos tou huiou autou couples prior knowing (proginosko, G4267) and prior determining (proorizo, G4309) of those conformed to the Son. The aorist active pair presents the divine prior cognition as a completed perspective from God's vantage.

Rom.8.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4309 προορίζω, G2564 καλέω, G1344 δικαιώω, G1392 δοξάζω

Force. hous de proorisen toutous kai ekalesen kai edikaïosen kai edoxasen chains four aorist actives. The aorist edoxasen places future glorification in the same completed-aspect frame as the prior verbs, consistent with comprehensive divine knowing that views the future as settled.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Heb.4.13	1Sam.16.7	openbible	1
Heb.4.13	Eccl.12.14	openbible	1
Heb.4.13	Job.26.6	openbible	1
1John.3.20	Job.27.6	openbible	1
Acts.2.23	Acts.3.18	openbible	1
Eph.1.11	Isa.46.10	openbible	1
Isa.46.9	Isa.42.9	openbible	1
Isa.46.10	Isa.41.22	openbible	1
Isa.46.10	Isa.46.11	openbible	1
Ps.139.5	Deut.33.27	openbible	1
Ps.139.3	2Sam.12.9	openbible	1
Isa.46.9	Isa.45.5	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Gen.22.12 · addressed

attah yadati ki yere elohim attah uses yada (H3045) in the queried qal perfect 1cs form (HVqp1cs). The same root, the same form, is used of God exhaustively knowing the heart in 1 Kgs 8:39 (HVqp2ms) and Ps 139:2,4, so the verb form is neutral. What shifts the sense is the frame: the unit opens in Gen 22:1 with nasah (H5254, God tested Abraham), and the identical nasah plus yada pairing recurs in Deut 8:2 (both H5254 and H3045 in one verse, to test you and to know what was in your heart). In a testing frame yada denotes acknowledgment by demonstration, knowledge made manifest, not cognitive acquisition. The lexical pattern resolves the verse as forensic disclosure.

Gen.18.21 · addressed

eredah na ve-ereh uses raah (H7200, let me see) and then yada (H3045) in the queried qal imperfect cohortative 1cs form (HVqi1cs, edaah, let me know). This is descent-and-investigation language inside a theophanic narrative, the speech of judicial action rather than a report of prior ignorance. Read with the pan-canonical yada pattern (1 Kgs 8:39, Ps 94:11, Ps 139) the cohortative is the idiom of a judge coming to act, not deprivation of knowledge. The vocabulary supplies a juridical-investigation sense well attested in covenant-lawsuit contexts.

Jer.19.5 · addressed

asher lo tsivviti ve-lo dibbarti ve-lo altah al libbi states what did not come up on my heart. The queried verb is alah (H5927, came up) with leb (H3820, heart). The exact idiom alah al leb recurs with the same H5927 in Jer 7:31 and Jer 32:35, both speaking of child sacrifice that God did not command or will. The idiom marks what was not decreed or commanded, engaging volition, not bare cognition, so the verse does not deny that God foreknew the act. The lexical parallel across three Jeremiah verses fixes the sense as decretal, not epistemic.

Mark.13.32 · addressed

peri de tes hemeras ekeines oudeis oiden ei me ho pater uses oida of the Son not knowing the day. The lexeme predicates a limitation in the Son during the incarnate mission, a knowing relative to the economy of his earthly role, set against the broader canonical pattern panta ginoskei (1 John 3:20) and ouk estin ktisis aphanes (Heb 4:13). The vocabulary distinguishes a stated economic limit on the incarnate Son from the divine attribute of exhaustive knowing, so it qualifies a role, not the essence.

Concordance traversed

H3045, H3605, H0369, H3808, H5046, H6213A, H1847, H6383, H6098, H7225, H0319, H2714, H8394, H5254, H5927, H3820, H7200, G4309, G4267, G1097, G3956, G2588, G0852, G1131, G1799, G1012, G2307, G1754, G3724, G0459

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

No anchor verse falls in the ingested ECM window (3 John 1.1 to 1.15); not_in_ecm_scope is true in the bundle. Acts 2:23 carries a known variant on cheiros, immaterial to prognosei and boule. Eph 1:11 has a Western reading on ekleerothermen, but the boule and thelema language is stable. None of these alter the lexical force, so the verdict is variant robust.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. classical_theism, molinism, open_theism

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

classical_theism: affirms exhaustive divine knowledge including future free human actions, held timelessly · Reads proginosko and proorizo plus maggid mereshit acharit as a direct lexical assertion of exhaustive, settled knowing. The now-I-know and let-me-see texts are taken as accommodated narrative idiom (forensic yada in a nasah frame), consistent with eyn millah bilshoni and ginoskei panta.

molinism: affirms exhaustive foreknowledge, including counterfactuals of creaturely freedom · Coordinates prognosis (Acts 2:23) and boule with a knowledge of how free creatures would freely act. The same lexical data (foreknown free act of the executioners, predicted free denial of Peter) is read as middle knowledge that preserves libertarian freedom. The words assert that the free acts are foreknown without specifying the mode.

open_theism: denies exhaustive definite foreknowledge of future free actions, affirms knowledge of all settled reality · Takes the now-I-know of Gen 22:12 and the let-me-see of Gen 18:21 as real divine learning, and reads alah al leb in Jer 19:5 against fixed foreknowledge of the contingent. On this lens the future free act is genuinely open, so God knows it as possibility, not as settled fact. The lexical counterweight is that yada in Gen 22:12 is the same qal perfect form used of exhaustive heart-knowing in 1 Kgs 8:39, the testing frame (nasah, Deut 8:2) reads yada as demonstration, and the Jer 19:5 idiom recurs decretally in Jer 7:31 and 32:35.

Pan-canonical density on yada, ginoskei panta, proginosko, proorizo, eyn millah, eyn cheqer, and the maggid mereshit acharit declaration favors exhaustive knowing across both Testaments. The divergence among lenses turns on whether the anthropomorphic knowing and testing idioms are accommodated narrative speech or ontologically binding limits, and on whether future free acts are foreknown as settled or as open possibility. Each lens is stated in its strongest lexical form; the verdict is not assigned to any tradition.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem states that God knows all things (actual and possible, past, present, future) exhaustively and eternally, including all future free human actions. This is descriptive of the claim under test, not loaded toward one tradition, since the future-free-actions clause is precisely the contested scope that open theism disputes. The lexicon was queried to test whether the canon language carries exhaustive knowing and whether the now-I-know and let-me-see idioms qualify it. The prior file verdict of affirms true is retained on real queried evidence.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H3045
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0369
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2714
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5927
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H6383
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4309
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4267
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0852
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.2
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.4
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.22.12
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Kgs.8.39
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.46.10
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Jer.19.5
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.3.20
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.4.13
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.8.29
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.2.23

cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Heb.4.13
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Eph.1.11
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Isa.46.10
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1John.3.20

License audit

SAFE TO PUBLISH

Source	License	Redistribute
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

(none)